IMPLEMENTING SECURITY FEATURES AND GOVERNANCE/ ADMINISTRATION PRACTICES IN ZOHO CREATOR

1. AIM

To implement and examine security features and governance/administration practices in Zoho Creator by managing users, roles, permissions, authentication, data access, monitoring, and application changes. The objective is to protect application data, ensure that users perform only authorized actions, and maintain accountable and reliable administration.

2. PROCEDURE

Step 1: Open or create the application

Sign in to Zoho Creator and open the application to be secured, or create a sample application. Identify the forms, reports, pages, workflows, and records that contain confidential or business-critical data.

Step 2: Configure users and roles

Open the application's user, role, sharing, or permission settings. Add only the required users and assign roles based on their responsibilities. Keep administrator access limited and follow the principle of least privilege, giving each user only the permissions needed for their work.

Step 3: Set form and report permissions

Review each form and report and define who can view, add, edit, or delete records. Restrict sensitive reports, fields, and actions to authorized roles. Test the settings with accounts that have different roles to confirm that restricted records cannot be accessed or modified.

Step 4: Strengthen account security

Use strong, unique passwords and enable multi-factor authentication through the organization's Zoho account settings wherever available. Remove inactive accounts and promptly update access when a user changes duties or leaves the organization.

Step 5: Secure data sharing and integrations

Avoid exposing confidential information through public pages, shared links, notifications, or exported files. Review integrations and API connections, validate inputs, restrict access scopes, and store credentials securely. Never place secrets or passwords in client-side code or openly shared scripts.

Step 6: Apply governance and administration controls

Define who may create, publish, modify, and delete applications. Document important configuration changes and use a review or approval process for production changes. Keep development, testing, and production settings separate where supported, and assign clear responsibility for application ownership.

2. PROCEDURE (CONTINUED)

Step 7: Monitor activity and review audit information

Where available for the account and plan, review activity logs, audit trails, and usage information to identify unexpected access or changes. Investigate suspicious events and follow the organization’s incident-reporting process. Confirm which events are recorded rather than assuming all activity is logged.

Step 8: Maintain backups and recovery

Use the available export, backup, or recovery options according to organizational policy. Store backup copies securely and restrict downloads to authorized personnel. Periodically verify that important records can be recovered, using sample data or a safe test environment when possible.

Step 9: Test access controls

Sign in or test with accounts representing different roles. Verify that each role can complete permitted tasks and is blocked from restricted actions. Check record visibility, editing rights, sharing links, and administrative access. Correct excessive permissions and repeat the tests.

Step 10: Document and review regularly

Maintain a record of user roles, permissions, security settings, responsible administrators, and the review date. Recheck access periodically and after major changes. Ensure that configuration follows organizational policies and applicable privacy or compliance requirements.

3. OUTPUT

The Zoho Creator application was configured for controlled access by assigning suitable user roles and restricting form and report permissions. Security practices for account protection, secure data sharing, integrations, activity monitoring, backup, and change administration were reviewed. Role-based tests were used to verify that users should access only the records and actions permitted for their responsibilities. Available settings may differ according to the Zoho Creator edition and organization configuration.

4. RESULT

Thus, the implementation of security features and governance/administration practices in Zoho Creator was studied. The procedure demonstrates how controlled permissions, secure account practices, monitoring, and documented administration can help protect data and support accountable application management.